FS Migration Validation Engine

Microsoft Founders Hub

Application Pack

Business Summary Document

Version 2.0 - June 2026

Status: Ready for Review

Table of Contents

Phase 1 - Azure Founders Hub Pack (v4 Cloud-Ready Edition)

Version: 2.0

Based on: FS Migration Validation Engine v1.4

Target Program: Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub

Status: Ready for Review

Executive Summary

This pack presents the FS Migration Validation Engine - an automated, metadata-driven data migration validation platform purpose-built for regulated Financial Services institutions.

After extensive technical analysis (Parts 1-4) covering legacy system assessment, current architecture evaluation, gap analysis, and migration strategy, we have transitioned from research into productization. This documentation pack represents the complete technical, commercial, and strategic foundation for Microsoft Founders Hub application.

Product Positioning

> *An Automated Data Migration Validation & Governance Platform for Regulated Financial Services.*

The platform is no longer just a data migration tool. It has evolved into an enterprise-grade Migration Assurance Platform that automates legacy system discovery, intelligent schema mapping, migration validation, governance, scoring, and compliance auditing for regulated financial data migrations.

The Five Platform Pillars

Pillar	Description	Status
1. Enterprise Discovery	Automated schema discovery, metadata extraction, dependency analysis	Built
2. Intelligent Mapping	Schema comparison, similarity matching, confidence scoring	Built
3. Migration Validation	10 structured controls, rule execution, exception tracking	Built
4. Governance & Audit	Version control, audit history, compliance reporting, release gates	Built
5. AI Intelligence Layer	AI-assisted mapping recommendations, analytics, copilot (future)	In Development

Document Inventory

#	Document	Audience	Purpose

#	Document	Audience	Purpose
1.1	Product Overview	Microsoft reviewers, investors	Executive summary, problem/solution, value proposition
1.2	Technical Architecture	Architecture reviewers, engineering	Platform architecture, components, data model
1.3	Platform Core Definition	Architecture reviewers	Orchestration layer, event bus, plugin framework
1.4	Azure Cloud Architecture	Microsoft reviewers, cloud architects	Azure service mapping, deployment, Well-Architected
1.5	Azure Reference Architecture Diagram	Technical reviewers	Visual architecture diagram, scalability, security boundaries
1.6	Technical Narrative	Founders Hub, investors	Full narrative: problem, solution, why Azure, roadmap

Evidence Portfolio

All claims in this pack are backed by working code and technical analysis:

Evidence	Reference	Status
Legacy Assessment	Part 1 Analysis	Complete
Current Architecture Assessment	Part 3 Analysis	Complete
Migration Strategy	Part 4 Analysis	Complete
Working CLI Engine	app/main.py - 10 controls, scoring, audit	Complete
FastAPI Endpoints	app/api/ - REST API layer	Complete
Database Schema	sql/schema/ - PostgreSQL engine schema	Complete
Docker Deployment	Dockerfile, docker-compose.yml	Complete
Governance Framework	Release gates, control dependencies, audit export	Complete
Gap Analysis	Phase 1.3 NOT_REQUIRED doc	Complete
Security Scanning	bandit-report.html, trivy-fs-report.txt	Complete

Target Market

Primary: Financial Services - Banks (Tier 1-3), Insurers, Asset Managers, FinTech, Regulated Enterprises

Secondary: Any organisation undertaking regulated data migration (Healthcare, Government, Utilities)

The platform is designed for organisations where data integrity, compliance, and auditability during migration are non-negotiable requirements.

Program Alignment

This documentation pack is designed for:

- Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub - Primary target
- AWS Activate - Adaptable with minor cloud service mapping changes
- Google for Startups - Adaptable with minor cloud service mapping changes
- Investor Due Diligence - Angel, Seed, Series A
- Enterprise Customer Evaluations - Technical and commercial reviews

Key Differentiators

Feature	Our Platform	Manual Approach	Legacy ETL Tools
Automated schema discovery	Automated	Manual analysis	Requires pre-configuration
10 structured validation controls	Built-in	Ad-hoc testing	[!]? Partial
Confidence scoring	Automated	Subjective	Not available
Audit trail & governance	Built-in	Manual documentation	[!]? Limited
Release gate enforcement	Automated	Manual approval	Not available
Control dependency management	Built-in	Manual sequencing	Not available
Docker deployment	Ready	N/A	[!]? Legacy installs
Financial Services focus	Purpose-built	Generic	Generic

Next Steps

Following this master overview, review the documents in order:

1. Phase 1.1 - Product Overview (non-technical executive summary)
2. Phase 1.2 - Technical Architecture (engineering deep-dive)
3. Phase 1.3 - Platform Core Definition (orchestration architecture)
4. Phase 1.4 - Azure Cloud Architecture (cloud-native migration plan)
5. Phase 1.5 - Azure Reference Architecture Diagram (visual architecture)
6. Phase 1.6 - Technical Narrative (complete Founders Hub narrative)
7. Phase 2.1-2.10 - Commercial & Investor Readiness Package

Phase 1.1 - Product Overview

Version: 2.0

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Target: Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub

Audience: Non-technical reviewers, investors, enterprise customers

Executive Summary

Financial Services institutions undertaking data migration projects face a fundamental challenge: how to ensure that millions of records move from legacy systems to modern platforms accurately, completely, and in compliance with regulatory requirements.

Traditional approaches rely on manual sampling, ad-hoc spreadsheet tracking, and post-migration firefighting. This is slow, error-prone, and unacceptable in regulated environments where data integrity failures can trigger regulatory penalties, operational losses, and reputational damage.

The FS Migration Validation Engine solves this by providing an automated, metadata-driven validation platform that systematically verifies every aspect of a data migration - from schema compatibility and data type correctness through to referential integrity, business rule compliance, and regulatory reporting accuracy.

The Problem

Data migration in Financial Services is high-risk and highly regulated:

Challenge	Impact
Manual validation	~60% of validation effort is manual and subjective
Incomplete coverage	Sampling-based checks miss edge cases and exceptions
Poor auditability	Spreadsheet-driven tracking fails regulatory scrutiny
No repeatability	Every migration project starts from scratch
High cost of failure	Data errors can cause operational losses, regulatory fines
Lack of governance	No formal release gates, approval workflows, or sign-off trails

Banks migrating core banking systems, payment platforms, or regulatory reporting systems cannot afford data quality failures. Yet most migration validation today relies on custom scripts, manual checks, and hope.

Our Solution

The FS Migration Validation Engine is an automated, metadata-driven validation and governance platform that:

1. Discovers legacy and target system schemas automatically
2. Validates data across 10 structured migration controls
3. Scores migration quality with objective, repeatable metrics
4. Governs the migration lifecycle with release gates and audit trails
5. Reports comprehensive audit evidence suitable for regulatory review

How It Works

```
Legacy System ??-> Discovery ??-> Validation Controls ??-> Scoring ??-> Audit Report
                                             ?
                                    Release Gate Review
                                             ?
                                  Migration Approved / Blocked
```

The platform runs as a CLI engine, REST API, or Docker container - integrating into existing CI/CD pipelines and deployment workflows.

Platform Capabilities

1. Automated Discovery

- Connect to source and target databases
- Discover schemas, tables, columns, and relationships
- Extract metadata for validation planning
- Identify schema differences automatically

2. Structured Validation Controls (C01-C010)

Control	Description
C01	Row count reconciliation
C02	Column-level data type validation
C03	Nullability constraint verification
C04	Primary key integrity check
C05	Foreign key referential integrity
C06	Business rule validation
C07	Date/time boundary validation
C08	Numeric range and precision checks

Control	Description
C09	String pattern and format validation
C010	Regulatory field completeness check

3. Scoring & Release Gates

- Each control receives an objective pass/fail score
- Aggregate scoring provides migration quality metrics
- Configurable release gates block migrations below minimum quality thresholds
- Dependency management ensures controls execute in correct order

4. Governance & Audit

- Every control execution is logged with timestamp and result
- Audit-ready CSV exports for regulatory review
- Batch-level tracking with unique batch IDs
- Exception register for all validation failures
- Full execution history for compliance reporting

5. REST API

- FastAPI-based RESTful interface
- Run validations programmatically
- Integrate with CI/CD pipelines
- Query results and export audits remotely

Business Benefits

Benefit	Measurable Impact
Reduced manual effort	70-80% reduction in manual validation work
Complete coverage	100% of records validated, not just samples
Regulatory compliance	Audit-ready evidence for every migration
Repeatable process	Standardised validation across all migration projects
Faster migrations	Automated gates replace manual review cycles
Lower risk	Early detection of data quality issues
Governance by design	Release gates prevent bad data reaching production

Current Development Status

Component	Status
CLI Engine (10 controls, scoring, audit)	Production-ready
REST API layer	Built (FastAPI)
Database schema (PostgreSQL)	Production-ready
Docker deployment	Ready
Control dependency DAG	Implemented
Release gate enforcement	Implemented
Audit export (CSV)	Implemented
Security scanning (bandit, trivy)	Integrated
Web dashboard	In development
AI-assisted mapping recommendations	Planned
Multi-tenant SaaS deployment	Planned

Why Azure

Microsoft Azure provides the enterprise-grade foundation required for regulated Financial Services deployments:

- Azure Container Apps - Scalable, serverless compute for the validation engine
- Azure SQL Database - Managed relational database with high availability
- Azure Blob Storage - Secure audit report and evidence storage
- Azure Key Vault - Encrypted secrets management for database credentials
- Microsoft Entra ID - Enterprise identity and role-based access control
- Azure Monitor - Centralised logging and performance monitoring
- Azure API Management - Secure API gateway for enterprise integration

The platform is designed to be Azure-native while supporting hybrid and on-premises deployment for customers with specific regulatory requirements.

Product Vision

Our vision is to become the standard platform for regulated data migration assurance - providing Financial Services institutions with the automation, governance, and auditability they need to migrate mission-critical data with confidence.

Future capabilities include:

- AI-assisted mapping recommendations - Using schema analysis to suggest optimal field mappings

- Intelligent mapping engine - Automated schema matching with confidence scoring
- Interactive dashboards - Real-time migration quality visualisation
- Multi-cloud support - Extend validation to AWS, GCP, and hybrid deployments
- Regulatory template library - Pre-built controls for specific regulations (Basel, SOX, FCA, PRA)

Competitive Advantages

Area	Our Advantage
Purpose-built	Designed specifically for regulated Financial Services data migration
10 structured controls	Comprehensive validation framework, not a generic ETL tool
Governance-first	Release gates, audit trails, and compliance built into every execution
Automated scoring	Objective, repeatable quality metrics - not subjective assessments
Docker-native	Deploy anywhere - cloud, on-premises, hybrid
API-first	Integrate with existing CI/CD and deployment pipelines
Open, extensible	Python-based, open architecture, easily customisable controls

Phase 1.2 - Technical Architecture

Business Summary

What the Platform Does

The FS Migration Validation Engine is an automated platform that ensures data moves accurately and completely from legacy financial systems to modern platforms. It connects to source and target databases, compares data across 10 structured validation checks, scores the migration quality, and produces audit-ready reports for regulatory review.

Why Azure Is the Right Foundation

The platform is built on Microsoft Azure to leverage enterprise-grade managed services that financial institutions require. Azure Container Apps provides scalable, serverless compute that automatically adjusts to workload demands. Azure SQL Database delivers a managed, highly available database with built-in backups and threat detection. Azure Key Vault ensures all credentials and secrets are encrypted and isolated from source code. This managed-service approach reduces operational overhead while meeting the security and compliance standards of regulated Financial Services.

Key Architectural Principles

The platform follows a modular, engine-based architecture where independent components (Discovery, Validation, Scoring, Governance) are coordinated through a central Platform Core. This design ensures that adding new validation controls or capabilities does not require re-architecting the system. Every validation execution is logged with timestamps and batch identifiers, creating a complete audit trail suitable for regulatory review. The platform is designed for horizontal scaling, allowing multiple validation workloads to run in parallel as customer demand grows.

Microsoft Ecosystem Alignment

The architecture aligns with the Azure Well-Architected Framework across all five pillars: Reliability, Security, Cost Optimization, Operational Excellence, and Performance Efficiency. The platform uses Infrastructure as Code (Bicep/ARM templates), CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions, and is designed for future integration with Microsoft Entra ID for enterprise identity management. This creates a clear path to Azure Marketplace distribution and long-term engagement with the Microsoft cloud ecosystem.

Phase 1.3 - Platform Core Definition

Business Summary

What the Platform Core Does

The Platform Core is the central coordination brain of the FS Migration Validation Engine. Rather than having each validation component communicate directly with every other component, the Platform Core acts as a single orchestration point that manages workflow sequencing, tracks execution state, enforces security, and ensures consistent configuration across all engines.

Why This Architecture Matters

This hub-and-spoke design dramatically reduces complexity. Each engine (Discovery, Validation, Scoring, Governance) operates independently and communicates only through the Platform Core. This means new validation capabilities can be added without modifying existing components, failures in one engine do not cascade to others, and the entire system can be tested, deployed, and scaled more easily.

Core Business Benefits

- Centralised Governance - Release gates, audit trails, and compliance controls are enforced consistently across all validation executions
- Failure Isolation - If one validation control encounters an error, it does not block or corrupt other controls
- Deterministic Results - The same input data always produces the same validation output, ensuring repeatability for regulatory review
- Enterprise-Grade Security - Authentication, authorisation, and audit logging are built into the core, not bolted on as afterthoughts

Azure Service Mapping

The Platform Core maps naturally to Azure managed services: Azure Container Apps for compute, Azure API Management for API gateway, Microsoft Entra ID for identity, Azure Key Vault for secrets, Azure Monitor for observability, and Azure SQL Database for persistent storage. This alignment means the platform can leverage Azure's enterprise features while maintaining a clear migration path as customer scale increases.

Phase 1.4 - Azure Cloud Architecture

Business Summary

Cloud-Native Design

The FS Migration Validation Engine is designed as an Azure-native, cloud-first solution. It leverages Microsoft's managed cloud services to maximise scalability, security, reliability, and operational efficiency for regulated Financial Services data migration validation. The architecture follows a Platform Core plus microservices model where independent domain engines are orchestrated through a central coordination layer.

Core Azure Services

The platform uses Azure Container Apps for scalable, serverless compute with automatic scaling based on validation workload. Azure API Management provides a secure gateway with rate limiting, versioning, and authentication. Azure SQL Database delivers a managed relational database with high availability and automated backups. Azure Blob Storage provides cost-effective, encrypted storage for audit artifacts and reports. Azure Key Vault manages all secrets and credentials with no credentials stored in source code. Azure Monitor and Application Insights provide comprehensive observability across infrastructure and application performance.

Security and Compliance

The platform follows a Zero Trust security model with Microsoft Entra ID for identity, private endpoints for all data services, encryption at rest and in transit, and continuous security assessment through Microsoft Defender for Cloud. Every validation execution is logged with batch identifiers and timestamps, creating audit evidence suitable for regulatory review.

Scalability and Cost

Each platform component scales independently based on workload demand using Azure Container Apps autoscaling. The consumption-based pricing model ensures costs align with actual usage, with projected MVP costs of approximately 560 to 1,220 pounds per month. Enterprise deployments with high availability configurations range from 2,000 to 5,000 pounds per month. As customer adoption grows, Azure consumption scales linearly across compute, storage, identity, and monitoring services.

Well-Architected Framework Alignment

The architecture aligns with all five pillars of the Azure Well-Architected Framework: Reliability through managed services with built-in redundancy; Security through Zero Trust architecture; Cost Optimization through consumption-based pricing and autoscaling; Operational Excellence through CI/CD and Infrastructure as Code; and Performance Efficiency through stateless design and independent engine scaling.

Phase 1.5 - Azure Reference Architecture

Business Summary

Architecture Overview

The FS Migration Validation Engine is built on an Azure-native reference architecture designed for enterprise-grade Financial Services deployments. The architecture consists of five distinct layers: Presentation, API, Platform Core, Domain Engines, and Data Storage, all supported by comprehensive monitoring and DevOps automation.

Platform Layers

The Presentation layer provides CLI and REST API interfaces for developers, DevOps teams, and auditors. The API layer uses Azure API Management for secure gateway functions with rate limiting and versioning, with future integration of Microsoft Entra ID for enterprise authentication. The Platform Core, running on Azure Container Apps, handles workflow orchestration, configuration management, security enforcement, and state tracking. Domain engines for Discovery, Validation, Scoring, Governance, and Export operate independently and are each deployable and scalable on their own.

Data and Storage

All operational data is stored in Azure SQL Database or PostgreSQL Flexible Server, providing managed, highly available storage with automated backups. Audit artifacts, reports, and logs are stored in Azure Blob Storage with tiered pricing for cost efficiency. All secrets, credentials, and encryption keys are managed through Azure Key Vault with no secrets stored in source code.

Security Boundaries

The architecture implements multiple security boundaries: private endpoints for all data services, Microsoft Entra ID for identity and access management, TLS 1.2 encryption for all communications, and comprehensive audit logging for every execution. This multi-layered approach meets the security requirements of regulated Financial Services environments.

Future Growth

The architecture is designed to support phased growth: Phase 2 adds AI-assisted mapping through Azure OpenAI and async processing via Azure Service Bus; Phase 3 introduces a web dashboard and multi-tenant SaaS capabilities; Phase 4 expands to partner integrations and Microsoft Fabric connectivity. Each phase leverages additional Azure services while maintaining the modular core architecture.

Phase 1.6 - Azure Founders Hub Technical Narrative

Version: 2.0

Program: Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Executive Summary

Our platform is an automated, metadata-driven data migration validation and governance platform purpose-built for regulated Financial Services institutions. It systematically validates data migrations across core banking, payments, lending, asset management, and regulatory reporting systems - ensuring accuracy, completeness, and regulatory compliance.

The solution is designed as an Azure-native, cloud-first platform that combines Microsoft's managed cloud services with intelligent automation to reduce the cost, complexity, and risk of financial data migrations. By adopting managed Azure services, a modular Platform Core architecture, and metadata-driven validation, we enable financial institutions to validate migrations with complete coverage, objective scoring, and auditable governance.

Business Problem

Financial Services institutions undertaking data migration projects face critical challenges:

Challenge	Impact
Regulatory scrutiny	FCA, PRA, Basel, and SOX require demonstrable data integrity
Manual validation	60%+ of validation effort is manual, subjective, and error-prone
Incomplete coverage	Sampling-based checks miss edge cases and exceptions
No repeatability	Every migration project reinvents validation from scratch
Poor audit trails	Spreadsheet tracking fails regulatory due diligence
High failure cost	Data errors cause operational losses, regulatory fines, reputational damage

These challenges are particularly acute in Financial Services, where a single data migration error can trigger regulatory penalties, operational disruptions, and significant financial loss.

Our Solution

The FS Migration Validation Engine provides:

1. Automated Schema Discovery - Connect to source and target databases, discover schemas, extract metadata
2. 10 Structured Validation Controls - Comprehensive validation framework covering row counts, data types, nullability, keys, referential integrity, business rules, date boundaries, numeric precision, string patterns, and regulatory completeness
3. Objective Quality Scoring - Automated pass/fail scoring with configurable thresholds
4. Release Gate Governance - Block migrations that fail to meet minimum quality standards
5. Audit-Ready Exports - CSV audit trails suitable for regulatory review
6. REST API - Programmatic integration with CI/CD pipelines and deployment workflows

Why Azure

Microsoft Azure provides the enterprise-grade foundation required for regulated Financial Services deployments:

Requirement	Azure Service
Scalable compute	Azure Container Apps - serverless, autoscaling
Managed database	Azure SQL Database - high availability, automated backups
Secure storage	Azure Blob Storage - encrypted, tiered, immutable storage
Secrets management	Azure Key Vault - no credentials in code
Identity & access	Microsoft Entra ID - enterprise-grade IAM
API management	Azure API Management - gateway, throttling, versioning
Monitoring	Azure Monitor + Application Insights - observability
Security	Microsoft Defender for Cloud - continuous assessment

Architectural alignment:

- Azure Well-Architected Framework (all 5 pillars)
- Cloud Adoption Framework
- Zero Trust security model
- Infrastructure as Code (Bicep / ARM)
- CI/CD with GitHub Actions / Azure DevOps

Platform Architecture

```
Users / CLI / API
       ?
???????????????
? Platform    ?
? Core        ?
???????????????
       ?
?????????????????????????????
?      ?      ?      ?      ?
Discovery Validation Scoring Governance
```

The Platform Core orchestrates execution across independent domain engines. Each engine communicates only with the Platform Core, ensuring loose coupling, independent scalability, and centralised governance.

Current implementation status:

Component	Status	Location in Codebase
CLI Engine	Production-ready	app/main.py, app/execution_engine.py
10 Validation Controls	Implemented	sql/controls/
Scoring Engine	Implemented	app/scoring_engine.py
Release Gates	Implemented	config.yaml - minimum score enforcement
Audit Export	Implemented	app/audit_export.py - CSV generation
REST API	Built	app/api/ - FastAPI endpoints
Docker Deployment	Ready	Dockerfile, docker-compose.yml
Database Schema	Production-ready	sql/schema/

Security Strategy

Implemented according to Zero Trust principles:

- No secrets in code - All credentials via environment variables -> Azure Key Vault
- Encryption at rest and in transit - TLS 1.2+, Azure SQL TDE, Blob encryption
- Audit logging - Every validation execution logged with batch ID and timestamp
- Failure isolation - Control-level isolation prevents cascade failures
- Release gates - Automated quality gates block non-compliant migrations

Competitive Advantages

Area	Our Advantage

Area	Our Advantage
Purpose-built	Designed for regulated Financial Services, not generic ETL
10 structured controls	Comprehensive, standardised validation framework
Governance-first	Release gates, audit trails, compliance built-in
Objective scoring	Automated, repeatable quality metrics
Docker-native	Deploy anywhere - cloud, on-premises, hybrid
API-first	Integrate with existing CI/CD pipelines
Open architecture	Python-based, extensible, plugin-ready

Scale & Performance

The platform is designed for enterprise-scale migration validation:

- Database discovery - Connect to multiple source and target databases
- Batch processing - Validate migrations in structured batch workflows
- Horizontal scaling - Stateless API design, containerised deployment
- Control isolation - Independent execution per control with failure isolation
- Configurable timeout - Per-control timeout (default: 300 seconds)

Roadmap

Phase	Capabilities	Timeline
Phase 1	CLI engine, 10 controls, scoring, audit, release gates	Complete
Phase 2	REST API, dashboard, AI-assisted mapping (Azure OpenAI)	In Development
Phase 3	Multi-tenant SaaS, web portal, interactive dashboards	Planned
Phase 4	Partner integrations, Microsoft Fabric, regulatory template library	Future

Value to Microsoft

This platform demonstrates effective use of the Microsoft ecosystem by:

- Building on Azure-native managed services (Container Apps, SQL, Blob, Key Vault)

- Following the Azure Well-Architected Framework across all 5 pillars
- Leveraging Microsoft Entra ID for enterprise identity (future)
- Supporting GitHub Actions / Azure DevOps for CI/CD
- Providing a scalable SaaS foundation suitable for Azure Marketplace
- Creating Azure consumption growth as customer adoption scales

As customer adoption grows, usage expands across Azure compute, storage, identity, AI, monitoring, and integration services - reinforcing long-term engagement with the Microsoft cloud platform.

Conclusion

The FS Migration Validation Engine represents a modern approach to data migration assurance for regulated Financial Services. Its automated validation framework, metadata-driven architecture, and Azure-native design provide financial institutions with the confidence, governance, and auditability required for mission-critical data migrations.

By aligning with Microsoft's architectural guidance and leveraging Azure's managed services, the platform is positioned to deliver measurable value to enterprise customers while demonstrating strong technical alignment with the goals of the Azure Founders Hub program.

Phase 2.1 - Executive Pitch Narrative

Version: 2.1

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Target: Microsoft Founders Hub, Investors, Enterprise Customers

Currency: GBP (£) - UK-based company

Vision

Financial Services institutions migrating mission-critical data between systems face a fundamental challenge: how to ensure accuracy, completeness, and regulatory compliance when millions of records are in motion.

Our vision is to make data migration validation automated, objective, and audit-ready - transforming it from a manual, high-risk exercise into a repeatable, governed, and verifiable process.

The Problem

Data migration in Financial Services is broken:

- Manual validation - Teams spend weeks manually sampling and checking data
- Incomplete coverage - Sampling misses edge cases and exceptions
- No standardisation - Every migration project reinvents validation from scratch
- Poor auditability - Spreadsheets and emails fail regulatory scrutiny
- High cost of failure - A single data error can cause operational losses, regulatory fines, and reputational damage

Banks migrating core banking systems, payment platforms, or regulatory reporting systems cannot afford data quality failures. Yet most validation today relies on custom scripts, manual checks, and hope.

Our Solution

The FS Migration Validation Engine is an automated, metadata-driven validation and governance platform that:

1. Discovers legacy and target system schemas automatically
2. Validates data across 10 structured migration controls
3. Scores migration quality with objective, repeatable metrics
4. Governs the migration lifecycle with release gates and audit trails
5. Reports comprehensive audit evidence suitable for regulatory review

How It Works

```
Legacy System -> Discovery -> 10 Validation Controls -> Scoring -> Release Gate -> Audit Report
```

The platform runs as a CLI engine, REST API, or Docker container - integrating into existing CI/CD pipelines and deployment workflows.

Why Now?

Several trends make this the right time for an automated migration validation platform:

Trend	Impact
Regulatory pressure	FCA, PRA, Basel IV, SOX demand demonstrable data integrity
Cloud migration acceleration	Banks are moving core systems to cloud at unprecedented pace
AI expectations	Institutions expect intelligent automation, not manual processes
Legacy system retirement	COBOL, mainframe, and legacy platform expertise is retiring
Cost pressure	Financial institutions need to reduce project costs and timelines

Why Azure?

Microsoft Azure provides the enterprise-grade foundation required for regulated Financial Services:

- Azure Container Apps - Scalable, serverless compute
- Azure SQL Database - Managed, highly available database
- Azure Key Vault - Secure secrets management
- Microsoft Entra ID - Enterprise identity and access
- Azure Monitor - Comprehensive observability
- Azure OpenAI - Future AI-assisted mapping capabilities

Competitive Advantage

Area	Our Advantage
Purpose-built	Designed for regulated Financial Services, not generic ETL
10 structured controls	Comprehensive, standardised validation framework
Governance-first	Release gates, audit trails, compliance built-in
Objective scoring	Automated, repeatable quality metrics
Docker-native	Deploy anywhere - cloud, on-premises, hybrid
API-first	Integrate with existing CI/CD pipelines

Business Model

The platform will be offered as a SaaS subscription with tiered pricing:

Tier	Target	Price Range (GBP/month)
Starter	Small migrations, pilot projects	£1,500-£3,500
Professional	Mid-size bank migrations	£3,500-£10,000
Enterprise	Large-scale, multi-system migrations	£10,000-£35,000
Strategic	Enterprise-wide deployment, custom controls	Custom pricing

Typical annual contract value: £30,000-£80,000 per customer

Additional revenue streams:

- Professional services (implementation, custom controls at £5k-£20k each)
- AI-assisted mapping module (future)
- Enterprise support and SLAs

Go-to-Market

Primary channels:

- Microsoft Founders Hub and Azure Marketplace
- Direct enterprise sales to UK Financial Services CTOs and Heads of Data
- System integrator partnerships (Accenture, Deloitte UK, Infosys UK)
- Microsoft partner network and co-sell programme

Target customers:

- Tier 1-3 Banks (Barclays, Lloyds, NatWest, challenger banks)
- Insurance companies (Aviva, Legal & General, AXA UK)
- Asset management firms
- FinTech and payment processors
- Regulated enterprises undergoing data migration

Product Roadmap

Phase	Capabilities	Timeline
Phase 1	CLI engine, 10 controls, scoring, audit, release gates	Complete
Phase 2	REST API, dashboard, AI-assisted mapping (Azure OpenAI)	In Development

Phase	Capabilities	Timeline
Phase 3	Multi-tenant SaaS, web portal, interactive dashboards	Planned
Phase 4	Partner integrations, Microsoft Fabric, regulatory template library	Future

Investment Opportunity

Azure Founders Hub support will accelerate:

- Product development - Complete Phase 2 (API, dashboard, AI mapping)
- Customer validation - Secure 5+ pilot customers in UK Financial Services
- Security certifications - ISO 27001, SOC 2 readiness
- Marketplace readiness - Azure Marketplace listing
- Commercial growth - Early customer acquisition targeting £450k ARR

Funding ask for Founders Hub: Azure credits (£120k max) + partner programme support

Seed round (if required): £500,000-£750,000

The platform is designed to grow Azure consumption as customers scale their migration initiatives, creating long-term value for both customers and the Microsoft ecosystem.

Closing Statement

Our mission is to transform data migration validation from a slow, manual, high-risk exercise into an automated, governed, and audit-ready process. By combining Azure-native architecture with intelligent automation, we aim to become the standard platform for regulated data migration assurance - helping Financial Services institutions migrate with confidence, compliance, and speed.

Phase 2.2 - Investor Pitch Deck

Version: 2.1

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Recommended Length: 14 Slides

Currency: GBP (£) - UK-based company

Slide 1 - Title

Data Migration Validation for Regulated Financial Services

FS Migration Validation Engine - Automated, Governed, Audit-Ready

Built on Microsoft Azure

\"Making data migration validation automated, objective, and compliant.\"

Slide 2 - The Problem

Data Migration Validation Is Broken

Financial Services institutions rely on:

- Manual sampling (weeks of effort, misses edge cases)
- Spreadsheet tracking (fails regulatory scrutiny)
- Custom scripts (not repeatable, not standardised)
- Gut feel and hope (not objective, not auditable)

Consequences:

- Regulatory fines for data integrity failures
- Operational losses from undetected errors
- Migration delays and budget overruns
- Reputational damage

Slide 3 - Market Opportunity

A Growing Regulatory Imperative

Target Market: Financial Services - Banks, Insurers, Asset Managers, FinTech

Market Drivers:

- Regulatory pressure (FCA, PRA, Basel IV, SOX)

- Accelerated cloud migration in Financial Services
- Legacy system retirement (COBOL, mainframe)
- AI and automation expectations

Market Size: Global data migration market projected to grow significantly as Financial Services accelerates cloud adoption.

Slide 4 - Our Solution

Automated Migration Validation Platform

The FS Migration Validation Engine provides:

Automated schema discovery - Connect, discover, and compare

10 structured validation controls - Comprehensive, standardised

Objective scoring - Automated pass/fail with configurable thresholds

Release gate governance - Block bad migrations before they reach production

Audit-ready exports - CSV trails suitable for regulatory review

Slide 5 - How It Works

Automated Validation Workflow

```
Legacy System
     v
Schema Discovery (automated)
     v
10 Validation Controls (C01-C010)
     v
Objective Scoring (pass/fail per control)
     v
Release Gate (min 80% score required)
     v
Audit Report (CSV export)
```

The platform runs as CLI, REST API, or Docker - integrating into any CI/CD pipeline.

Slide 6 - Why We're Different

Feature	Manual / Custom	Our Platform
Schema discovery	Manual analysis	Automated
Validation coverage	Sampling (~20%)	100% of records
Scoring	Subjective	Objective metrics
Governance	Spreadsheet tracking	Release gates + audit

Feature	Manual / Custom	Our Platform
Repeatability	None (new scripts each time)	Standardised framework
Regulatory audit	Manual evidence gathering	Automated CSV export

Slide 7 - Technology

Azure-Native Architecture

Built on Microsoft Azure:

- Azure Container Apps - Serverless compute
- Azure SQL Database - Managed, HA database
- Azure Key Vault - Secrets management
- Microsoft Entra ID - Enterprise IAM (future)
- Azure Monitor - Observability
- Azure API Management - API gateway

Architecture: Platform Core + microservices - modular, extensible, cloud-native.

Slide 8 - Business Model

SaaS Subscription Pricing

Tier	Target Customer	Price (GBP/month)
Starter	Pilot projects, small migrations	£1,500-£3,500
Professional	Mid-size bank migrations	£3,500-£10,000
Enterprise	Large-scale migrations	£10,000-£35,000
Strategic	Enterprise-wide deployment	Custom

Additional: Professional services, AI mapping module (future), support/SLAs.

Slide 9 - Go-to-Market

Channel Strategy

Primary:

- Microsoft Founders Hub -> Azure Marketplace
- Direct enterprise sales (CTOs, Heads of Data)
- System integrator partnerships (Accenture, Deloitte, Infosys)

Target Verticals:

- Tier 1-3 Banks

- Insurance companies
- Asset management
- FinTech / payments
- Regulated enterprises

Slide 10 - Product Roadmap

Growth Plan

Phase	Capabilities	Status
Phase 1	CLI engine, 10 controls, scoring, audit	Complete
Phase 2	REST API, dashboard, AI mapping (Azure OpenAI)	In Development
Phase 3	Multi-tenant SaaS, web portal	Planned
Phase 4	Marketplace, Fabric integration, regulatory templates	Future

Slide 11 - Why Microsoft

Built for Azure

Our platform increases Azure consumption through:

- Azure Container Apps
- Azure SQL Database
- Azure Blob Storage
- Azure Key Vault
- Azure OpenAI (future)
- Azure Monitor

Alignment:

- Azure Well-Architected Framework
- Cloud Adoption Framework
- Zero Trust security
- Marketplace readiness

Slide 12 - Investment Opportunity

Use of Funds

Support from Founders Hub will accelerate:

Area	Allocation
Product development (Phase 2)	40%
AI mapping module (Azure OpenAI)	20%
Customer pilots & validation	20%
Security certifications	10%
Marketplace readiness	10%

Slide 13 - Vision

The Future

Our goal is to become the standard platform for regulated data migration assurance.

Future capabilities:

- AI-assisted mapping recommendations
- Intelligent mapping engine with confidence scoring
- Interactive dashboards
- Regulatory template library (Basel, SOX, FCA, PRA)
- Multi-cloud support (AWS, GCP)

Slide 14 - Closing

Migration Validation Starts with Certainty

\"Don't guess your migration quality - validate it.\"

FS Migration Validation Engine

Built on Microsoft Azure

Contact: [Your Contact Information]

Phase 2.3 - Market Analysis

TAM - SAM - SOM - Competitor Landscape

Version: 2.0

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Target: Financial Services Data Migration Validation Market

Executive Summary

The FS Migration Validation Engine addresses a growing and critical market: automated data migration validation for regulated Financial Services. As banks and financial institutions accelerate cloud migration, the need for automated, governed, and audit-ready validation becomes a regulatory and operational necessity.

The market is distinct from generic ETL, data quality, or testing tools - it sits at the intersection of RegTech (Regulatory Technology) , data migration, and enterprise governance.

Market Drivers

Regulatory Pressure

Financial regulators globally are demanding demonstrable data integrity:

- FCA (UK) - Operational resilience and data integrity requirements
- PRA (UK) - Prudential regulation data standards
- Basel IV - Enhanced data quality and reporting requirements
- SOX (US) - Financial reporting data integrity
- GDPR - Data protection during migration

Cloud Migration Acceleration

Financial Services cloud adoption is accelerating:

- 70%+ of banks have active cloud migration programmes
- Core banking system modernisation is a top 3 priority
- Regulatory reporting systems moving to cloud-native platforms

Legacy System Retirement

Critical legacy platforms are losing expert support:

- COBOL, mainframe, PowerBuilder, Oracle Forms
- Retiring workforce with platform-specific knowledge
- Urgent need for automated migration assurance

AI & Automation Expectations

Financial institutions expect intelligent automation:

- Manual validation is no longer acceptable
- AI-assisted mapping and validation is the expected standard
- Governance and audit must be automated, not manual

Target Market

Primary Customers

Segment	Examples	Pain Point
Tier 1 Banks	HSBC, Barclays, Lloyds, NatWest	Multi-system migrations, regulatory scrutiny
Tier 2-3 Banks	Metro Bank, Virgin Money, challenger banks	Migration cost and risk reduction
Insurance	Aviva, Legal & General, AXA	Policy and claims data migration
Asset Management	BlackRock, Schroders, Legal & General IM	Fund data accuracy during migration
FinTech / Payments	Wise, Revolut, Checkout.com	Rapid migration cycles, compliance requirements
Regulated Enterprises	Healthcare, Government, Utilities	Data integrity obligations

Secondary Customers

Segment	Opportunity
System Integrators	Accenture, Deloitte, Infosys - embed as migration assurance tool
Cloud Migration Practices	Microsoft consulting partners, cloud migration specialists
Audit & Compliance Firms	Big 4 audit firms - use for migration audit evidence

Total Addressable Market (TAM)

The TAM encompasses global spend on:

- Financial Services data migration projects

- RegTech solutions for data governance and compliance
- Enterprise data quality and validation tools
- Cloud migration assurance services

Estimated global TAM: $8-12 billion annually

Note: Independent analyst data (Gartner, IDC) should be sourced for final figures.

Serviceable Available Market (SAM)

The SAM focuses on organisations that:

- Operate within the Microsoft Azure ecosystem
- Are undertaking active data migration projects
- Have regulatory compliance requirements
- Prefer SaaS-based tooling over custom builds

Estimated SAM: $1.5-2.5 billion annually

Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)

The initial SOM targets:

- UK Financial Services institutions (50+ Tier 1-3 banks, insurers, asset managers)
- Microsoft Azure-committed organisations
- Early adopters of automated migration governance
- Phase 1: 10-20 enterprise customers

Estimated SOM (Year 1-2): $10-30 million annually

Competitive Landscape

Category 1: Manual / In-House Solutions

Description: Custom scripts, spreadsheets, manual sampling

Strengths: Familiar, no licensing cost

Weaknesses: Not scalable, no governance, error-prone, no audit trail

Our Advantage: Automation, repeatability, governance, audit readiness

Category 2: ETL Testing Tools

Examples: QuerySurge, iCEDQ, Datagaps

Strengths: Data comparison capabilities

Weaknesses: Generic, not purpose-built for migration, limited governance

Our Advantage: Migration-specific controls, release gates, financial services focus

How They Compare:

Capability	Our Platform	ETL Testing Tools	Manual
Purpose-built for migration	Yes	Generic testing	
10 structured controls	Built-in	[!]? Partial	
Release gate governance	Built-in		
Audit trail	Automated	[!]? Limited	
Financial Services focus	Purpose-built		
Docker deployment	Ready		N/A
API-first	Built	[!]? Partial	

Category 3: Data Quality Platforms

Examples: Informatica, Talend, Ataccama

Strengths: Broad data quality capabilities

Weaknesses: Complex, expensive, not migration-specific, long implementation

Our Advantage: Migration-focused, lightweight deployment, faster time-to-value

Category 4: Big 4 & SI Migration Practices

Examples: Accenture Migration Factory, Deloitte Migration Services

Strengths: Domain expertise, end-to-end service

Weaknesses: High cost, manual-heavy, not repeatable across clients

Our Advantage: Automated platform, consistent methodology, lower cost

Category 5: Cloud-Native Migration Tools

Examples: Azure Migrate, AWS Migration Hub, Google Cloud Migration

Strengths: Cloud infrastructure integration

Weaknesses: Infrastructure-focused, limited data validation, no governance

Our Advantage: Data-level validation, governance, Financial Services compliance

Competitive Positioning

Our platform occupies a unique position at the intersection of:

- RegTech - Regulatory compliance for data migration
- Data Validation - Automated, comprehensive, repeatable
- Migration Governance - Release gates, audit, compliance
- Azure-Native - Purpose-built for Microsoft ecosystem

Key message: Not a generic testing tool - a purpose-built Migration Assurance Platform for regulated Financial Services.

Market Entry Strategy

Phase	Focus	Activities
Year 1	UK Financial Services	Microsoft Founders Hub, pilot customers, direct sales
Year 2	UK + Europe	Azure Marketplace, SI partnerships, industry events
Year 3	North America	Microsoft co-sell, multi-region deployments
Year 4+	Global	Marketplace ecosystem, regulatory template library

Growth Opportunities

Opportunity	Description
Regulatory template library	Pre-built controls for Basel, SOX, FCA, PRA
AI-assisted mapping	Azure OpenAI-powered schema matching
Multi-cloud validation	Extend to AWS, GCP migrations
Dashboard & reporting	Interactive visualisation of migration quality
Managed migration service	Platform + implementation consulting
Partner ecosystem	SI embed, marketplace, co-sell

Phase 2.4 - Business Model & Pricing Strategy

Version: 2.1

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Currency: GBP (£) - UK-based company

Executive Summary

The FS Migration Validation Engine follows a SaaS subscription model with tiered pricing based on migration project volume, number of systems, and support level. The model is designed for predictable recurring revenue (ARR) while allowing expansion through professional services and future AI modules.

Revenue is generated from four complementary streams:

1. Enterprise SaaS subscriptions - Core recurring revenue
2. Professional services - Implementation, custom controls, migration advisory
3. Enterprise support & SLAs - Premium support tiers (future)
4. AI mapping module - Azure OpenAI-powered recommendations (future)

Revenue Streams

1. SaaS Subscriptions (Primary)

Tier	Target	Price (GBP/month)	Includes
Starter	Pilot projects, small migrations	£1,500-£3,500	1 migration project, 2 databases, CLI access
Professional	Mid-size bank migrations	£3,500-£10,000	3 concurrent projects, 5 databases, API access
Enterprise	Large-scale migrations	£10,000-£35,000	Unlimited projects, multi-database, audit export, priority support
Strategic	Enterprise-wide deployment	Custom	Custom controls, multi-region, dedicated support, SLA

Typical annual contract value (ACV): £30,000-£80,000 per customer - consistent with UK enterprise regtech SaaS benchmarks.

2. Professional Services

Service	Description	Price (GBP)
Implementation	Platform setup, CI/CD integration, customer onboarding	£15,000-£40,000

Service	Description	Price (GBP)
Custom Controls	Development of customer-specific validation rules	£5,000-£20,000 per control
Migration Advisory	Migration validation planning and governance consulting	£1,500-£7,500/day

Professional services are typically 15-20% of total revenue in Years 1-2, reducing to 5-10% as the platform scales - consistent with SaaS industry benchmarks.

3. Future Revenue Streams

Stream	Description	Expected Launch
AI Mapping Module	Azure OpenAI-powered schema mapping recommendations	Phase 2 (Year 2)
Enterprise Support & SLA	24/7 support, guaranteed SLAs, account management	Phase 3 (Year 2-3)
Regulatory Templates	Pre-built controls for specific regulations (Basel, SOX, FCA, PRA)	Phase 3 (Year 3)

Revenue Model Rationale

The pricing model is based on:

- Value-based pricing - Priced on migration project value (typically £500k-£5M per programme), not per-record. A validation platform delivering 0.5-1% risk reduction on a £2M migration programme justifies £50k-£100k annual investment.
- Tiered progression - Clear upgrade path from pilot (£1.5k/mo) to enterprise-scale (£35k+/mo) as customers expand usage.
- Subscription model - Predictable ARR with annual contracts (typical UK enterprise procurement).
- Low upfront, high lifetime - Low barrier to entry (£1.5k/mo starter), high expansion revenue as customers validate more migrations.

Unit Economics (Illustrative)

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Customers	10	40	120
Average ARR/Customer	£45,000	£60,000	£70,000
ARR	£450,000	£2,400,000	£8,400,000
Gross Margin	78%	82%	85%
CAC	£28,000	£22,000	£18,000
LTV (avg 4 years)	£180,000	£240,000	£280,000

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
LTV:CAC	6:1	11:1	16:1

Notes:

- CAC includes founder-led sales time (Year 1) and dedicated sales resource (Years 2-3)
- LTV:CAC ratio of 6:1 in Year 1 is healthy for enterprise SaaS; improves to 16:1 at scale
- Churn expected at <10% in Year 1, declining to <5% by Year 3 - consistent with enterprise regtech benchmarks

Azure Infrastructure Cost Model

Service	Monthly (GBP) - MVP	Monthly (GBP) - Scale
Azure Container Apps	£150-£400	£800-£2,500
Azure SQL Database	£120-£250	£400-£1,200
Azure Blob Storage	£40-£80	£150-£400
Azure API Management	£80-£150	£250-£500
Azure Key Vault	£8-£15	£40-£80
Azure Monitor	£40-£80	£150-£400
Total per customer	£438-£975	£1,790-£5,080

As the platform moves to multi-tenant SaaS, infrastructure costs per customer reduce significantly through shared tenancy.

Pricing Principles

Principle	Rationale
Value-based	Priced on migration project value, not per-record
Tiered	Clear upgrade path as customer needs grow
Subscription	Predictable recurring revenue (ARR) - essential for UK investors
Enterprise annual contracts	Standard UK enterprise procurement model - annual commitments
Low entry, high expansion	Starter tier for pilots, expansion revenue from Enterprise tier

UK Market Context

This pricing reflects UK Financial Services market conditions:

- UK banks typically spend £500k-£5M per migration programme
- UK enterprise regtech SaaS pricing ranges £30k-£150k ACV

- UK investors expect GBP-denominated projections with realistic UK salary costs
- UK corporate tax rate: 25% (2024-25)
- R&D tax credits available for software development (up to 27% of qualifying costs)
- Azure Founders Hub provides up to £120,000 in free Azure credits (GBP equivalent of $150k)

Azure Marketplace Strategy

The platform will be available through:

- Azure Marketplace - Transactable SaaS offer (GBP pricing)
- Microsoft Co-Sell - Eligible for Microsoft field seller incentives
- Private Offers - Custom pricing for large enterprise deals

This aligns with Microsoft's partner ecosystem and provides UK Financial Services customers with Azure consumption commitment benefits.

Phase 2.5 - Go-to-Market Strategy & 3-Year Financial Projections

Version: 2.1

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Currency: GBP (£) - UK-based company

Go-to-Market Strategy

Target Customer Segments

Primary (Year 1-2):

Segment	Target	Entry Strategy
Tier 2-3 Banks	UK challenger banks, building societies	Direct founder-led sales, pilot projects
Insurance	UK insurers with migration programmes	Microsoft partner referrals
FinTech	Payment processors, digital banks	Azure Marketplace listing

Secondary (Year 2-3):

Segment	Target	Entry Strategy
Tier 1 Banks	Barclays, Lloyds, HSBC, NatWest	SI partnerships, longer sales cycles
Asset Management	Fund managers, wealth platforms	Industry events, case studies
Regulated Enterprises	Healthcare, Government	Compliance-led positioning

Go-to-Market Channels

Channel	Year 1 Contribution	Year 2 Contribution	Year 3 Contribution
Direct Sales (founder-led)	60%	40%	25%
Azure Marketplace	20%	25%	30%
System Integrators	10%	20%	25%
Microsoft Co-Sell	5%	10%	15%
Inbound / Content	5%	5%	5%

Sales Cycle

Segment	Cycle Length	Key Decision Makers
Small/Medium Banks	2-4 months	CTO, Head of Data, Programme Director
Large Banks	6-12 months	CIO, CRO, Head of Migration
Insurance	3-6 months	CTO, Head of Transformation

Segment	Cycle Length	Key Decision Makers
FinTech	1-3 months	CTO, VP Engineering

Customer Acquisition Strategy

Year 1:

- Secure 3-5 pilot customers in UK Financial Services
- Build case studies and reference accounts
- Establish Azure Marketplace presence
- Leverage Azure Founders Hub credits (£120k) for infrastructure

Year 2:

- Scale to 20-30 customers across UK + Europe
- Establish SI partnerships (2-3 partners - Accenture, Deloitte UK, Infosys UK)
- ISO 27001 certification

Year 3:

- 80-100 customers globally
- Microsoft co-sell programme participation
- North America market entry (with USD pricing option)

3-Year Financial Projections

Revenue Forecast

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Customers	10	40	120
Average ARR/Customer	£45,000	£60,000	£70,000
SaaS Revenue	£450,000	£2,400,000	£8,400,000
Professional Services	£100,000	£300,000	£500,000
Total Revenue	£550,000	£2,700,000	£8,900,000

Revenue assumptions:

- Year 1: 10 customers at £3,750/mo average (£45k ARR) + implementation fees
- Year 2: 40 customers at £5,000/mo average (£60k ARR) - expansion revenue from existing customers via up-sell
- Year 3: 120 customers at £5,833/mo average (£70k ARR) - mix of new logos and expansion
- Professional services: 1 implementation per new customer (£15k-£30k each)
- Churn: 10% Year 1 -> 8% Year 2 -> 5% Year 3

Cost of Sales

Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Azure Infrastructure	£60,000	£240,000	£720,000
Customer Support (1 FTE)	£40,000	£80,000	£200,000
Third-party Licences	£20,000	£50,000	£100,000
Total CoS	£120,000	£370,000	£1,020,000
Gross Margin	78%	86%	89%

Cost assumptions:

- Azure costs reduce per-customer as shared tenancy scales
- Support: 0.5 FTE in Year 1 -> 2 FTE by Year 3
- Third-party: GitHub, monitoring, security scanning tools

Operating Expenses

Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Salaries & Benefits			
Founder/CEO	£60,000	£70,000	£80,000
Senior Engineer (Python/Azure)	£90,000	£95,000	£100,000
Junior Engineer	£50,000	£55,000	£60,000
Sales/Business Development	-	£60,000	£80,000
Customer Success	-	-	£55,000
Total Salaries	£200,000	£280,000	£375,000
Employer NI & Pension (est. 20%)	£40,000	£56,000	£75,000
Total Staff Costs	£240,000	£336,000	£450,000
Other OpEx			
Office & Equipment	£30,000	£40,000	£60,000
Sales & Marketing	£40,000	£100,000	£200,000
Professional Advisors (legal, accounting)	£25,000	£35,000	£50,000
Insurance & Compliance	£15,000	£25,000	£40,000
Travel & Events	£10,000	£30,000	£50,000
R&D (non-staff)	£20,000	£30,000	£50,000
Total Other OpEx	£140,000	£260,000	£450,000
Total Operating Expenses	£380,000	£596,000	£900,000

Salary assumptions reflect UK market rates (outside London):

- Senior Python/Azure engineer: £85k-£100k typical for UK startup/FInTech

- Junior engineer: £45k-£55k
- Sales: £55k-£70k base + commission
- Employer NI (13.8%) + pension (3-5%) estimated at 20% on total salary

EBITDA

Year	Revenue	Total Costs (CoS + OpEx)	EBITDA
Year 1	£550,000	£500,000	£50,000
Year 2	£2,700,000	£966,000	£1,734,000
Year 3	£8,900,000	£1,920,000	£6,980,000

Year 1 reaches break-even with £50k EBITDA - achievable due to founder-led sales, low overhead, and Azure Founders Hub credits covering infrastructure.

Key Metrics

KPI	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Benchmark
ARR	£450,000	£2,400,000	£8,400,000	UK regtech median: £500k->£3M->£10M+
Gross Margin	78%	86%	89%	SaaS target: >70% Year 1, >80% by Year 3
Net Revenue Retention	105%	115%	125%	Enterprise SaaS median: 110%+
Customer Churn	<10%	<8%	<5%	Enterprise target: <10% annual
CAC	£28,000	£22,000	£18,000	UK enterprise SaaS: £15k-£35k
LTV	£180,000	£240,000	£280,000	Based on 4-year avg customer life
LTV:CAC	6:1	11:1	16:1	Healthy SaaS: >3:1, Great: >10:1
EBITDA Margin	9%	64%	78%	UK SaaS Rule of 40 target
Headcount	3	5	8	Capital-efficient - typical UK startup

Funding Requirement

Target: £500,000-£750,000 Seed Round (optional - can bootstrap if Founders Hub credits sufficient)

Use of Funds:

Area	Allocation	Amount (GBP)
Product Development (Phase 2)	40%	£200,000-£300,000

Area	Allocation	Amount (GBP)
AI Mapping Module (Azure OpenAI)	20%	£100,000-£150,000
Customer Pilots & Validation	20%	£100,000-£150,000
Security Certifications (ISO 27001)	10%	£50,000-£75,000
Marketplace & Sales Readiness	10%	£50,000-£75,000

Alternative Path: Azure Founders Hub provides up to £120,000 in Azure credits. Combined with founder funding and early customer revenue, the business can reach breakeven without external equity in Year 1.

UK-specific funding options:

- Azure Founders Hub - £120k Azure credits + support
- Innovate UK Smart Grants - Up to £500k for R&D projects
- UK Enterprise Investment Scheme (EIS) - Tax relief for angel investors (30% income tax relief)
- British Business Bank Start Up Loans - Up to £25k per founder

Phase 2.6 - Financial Model & Funding Strategy

Version: 2.1

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Currency: GBP (£) - UK-based company

Financial Model Summary

3-Year P&L

Item	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Customers	10	40	120
SaaS Revenue	£450,000	£2,400,000	£8,400,000
Professional Services	£100,000	£300,000	£500,000
Total Revenue	£550,000	£2,700,000	£8,900,000
Cost of Sales	(£120,000)	(£370,000)	(£1,020,000)
Gross Profit	£430,000	£2,330,000	£7,880,000
OpEx (Staff + Other)	(£380,000)	(£596,000)	(£900,000)
EBITDA	£50,000	£1,734,000	£6,980,000
EBITDA Margin	9%	64%	78%

The business reaches EBITDA-positive in Year 1 - achievable through low overhead, founder-led operations, and Azure Founders Hub credits (£120k) covering infrastructure costs.

Revenue Build-Up

Component	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Assumption
New customers	10	30	80	Growth driven by founder-led sales + SI
Retained customers	-	9	37	90% retention Year 1 -> 92% Year 2
Total customers (EoY)	10	40	120	Net growth after churn
Average ARR/customer	£45,000	£60,000	£70,000	Expansion via up-sell + new logos
SaaS ARR	£450,000	£2,400,000	£8,400,000	Recurring subscription revenue
Professional services	£100,000	£300,000	£500,000	Implementation + custom controls

Azure Infrastructure Cost Model

Service	Monthly (MVP)	Monthly (Scale)
Azure Container Apps	£150-£400	£800-£2,500
Azure SQL Database	£120-£250	£400-£1,200
Azure Blob Storage	£40-£80	£150-£400
Azure API Management	£80-£150	£250-£500
Azure Key Vault	£8-£15	£40-£80
Azure Monitor	£40-£80	£150-£400
Monthly Total	£438-£975	£1,790-£5,080
Annual Total per customer	£5,256-£11,700	£21,480-£60,960

Year 1: Single-tenant deployment costs ~£5k/customer/year.

Year 3: Multi-tenant SaaS model reduces per-customer costs to £1k-£2k/customer/year.

Hiring Plan

Year	Role	Salary (GBP)	Notes
Y1	Founder/CEO	£60,000	UK founder salary, below market
Y1	Senior Engineer (Python/Azure)	£90,000	UK market rate for senior engineer
Y1	Junior Engineer	£50,000	UK graduate + 1-2 years experience
Y2	Sales/Business Development	£60,000 + commission	Target for 30 new customers
Y3	Customer Success	£55,000	Support 120 customer accounts
Y3	Additional Engineer	£65,000	Scale development capacity

All salaries based on UK market rates (outside London). Employer NI (13.8%) + pension (3-5%) = ~20% on top.

Funding Strategy

Azure Founders Hub (Primary - Year 1)

Benefit	Value (GBP)
Free Azure credits	Up to £120,000
Microsoft partner enrolment	Free
Azure Marketplace listing	Included
Technical support	Included
Go-to-market support	Included

The Founders Hub credits alone cover Year 1 Azure infrastructure (£60k), with remaining credits available for development and testing environments.

Seed Round (If Required)

Item	Detail
Target	£500,000-£750,000
Valuation basis	UK angel/Seed typical: £1.5M-£3M pre-money for SaaS with working prototype
Use	Product development, AI module, customer pilots, security certifications
Timing	End of Year 1, after Founders Hub credits utilised
Investor target	UK angel networks, EIS-qualified investors

Future Funding

Round	Target	Timing	Trigger
Seed	£500k-£750k	Year 1-2	Product validation, 10+ customers, £450k ARR
Series A	£3M-£5M	Year 3	£2M+ ARR, proven GTM, SI partnerships

UK-Specific Funding Options

Source	Amount	Eligibility
Azure Founders Hub	Up to £120k credits	Startup stage
Innovate UK Smart Grant	Up to £500k	R&D projects, competitive application
EIS (Enterprise Investment Scheme)	Tax relief for investors	Must be EIS-qualified company
UK SEIS	Up to £250k investment	Early-stage, less than 2 years old
British Business Bank	Various	Startup loans, growth guarantee

Sensitivity Analysis

Scenario: Slower Customer Acquisition

Metric	Base Case	Downside (-30%)	Upside (+30%)
Year 1 customers	10	7	13
Year 1 revenue	£550,000	£385,000	£715,000
Year 1 EBITDA	£50,000	(£115,000)	£215,000
Year 3 ARR	£8.4M	£5.9M	£10.9M
Breakeven	Year 1	Year 2 (Q3)	Year 1

The business model is resilient - even at 30% lower customer acquisition, breakeven is achieved by mid-Year 2 due to low fixed costs and variable infrastructure spend.

Phase 2.7 - Competitive Differentiation

Version: 2.0

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Competitive Landscape

Category	Typical Vendors	Strengths	Weaknesses	Our Advantage
Manual / In-House	Custom scripts, spreadsheets	Familiar, no license cost	Not scalable, no governance	Automation, repeatability, audit
ETL Testing Tools	QuerySurge, iCEDQ, Datagaps	Data comparison	Not migration-focused, limited governance	Migration-specific controls, release gates
Data Quality Platforms	Informatica, Talend, Ataccama	Broad data quality	Complex, expensive, long implementation	Lightweight, migration-focused, faster
Big 4 / SI Services	Accenture, Deloitte Migration Services	Domain expertise	High cost, manual-heavy, not repeatable	Automated platform, consistent methodology
Cloud Migration Tools	Azure Migrate, AWS Migration Hub	Infrastructure integration	Infrastructure-focused, limited data validation	Data-level validation, governance, compliance

Differentiation Matrix

Capability	Our Platform	ETL Testing	Data Quality	Manual
Purpose-built for migration				
10 structured controls		[!]?	[!]?	
Release gate governance				
Audit trail (automated)		[!]?	[!]?	
Financial Services focus				
Docker deployment			[!]?	N/A
API-first		[!]?	[!]?	
Objective scoring		[!]?	[!]?	

Core Differentiators

1. Purpose-Built for Migration

Not a general-purpose testing or data quality tool - designed specifically for data migration validation with 10 structured controls that cover the complete migration lifecycle.

2. Governance-First Design

Release gates, audit trails, exception registers, and compliance reporting are built into every execution - not added as afterthoughts.

3. Financial Services Focus

Purpose-built for regulated environments. Controls align with regulatory requirements (FCA, PRA, Basel, SOX).

4. Lightweight Deployment

Docker-native, deploy in minutes. No complex installation, no heavy infrastructure requirements.

5. API-First Architecture

Integrate with existing CI/CD pipelines, deployment workflows, and enterprise toolchains.

6. Objective, Repeatable Scoring

Automated scoring removes subjectivity. Same inputs always produce same outputs - essential for regulated environments.

Why Customers Choose Our Platform

Customer Need	Manual Approach	Our Platform
Complete validation coverage	Sampling only (~20%)	100% of records
Regulatory audit evidence	Manual evidence gathering	Automated CSV export
Repeatable process	New scripts each migration	Standardised framework
Migration governance	Spreadsheet tracking	Release gates + audit
Objective quality metrics	Subjective assessment	Automated scoring
Fast deployment	Weeks of setup	Docker, minutes to deploy

Phase 2.8 - Product Roadmap

Version: 2.0

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Vision

To become the standard platform for regulated data migration assurance - helping Financial Services institutions validate every data migration with automated controls, objective scoring, and auditable governance.

Product Evolution

```
MVP (CLI Engine)
    ?
    v
Enterprise API Platform (REST API + Dashboard)
    ?
    v
AI-Assisted Migration (Azure OpenAI Mapping)
    ?
    v
Multi-Tenant SaaS (Web Portal + Marketplace)
    ?
    v
Intelligent Migration Platform (AI Agents + Fabric)
```

Year 1 - Foundation & Validation (Current)

Objective

Establish the platform with Financial Services customers and validate product-market fit.

Completed

Capability	Status
CLI Engine (10 controls)	Complete
PostgreSQL schema	Complete
Scoring engine	Complete
Release gates	Complete
Audit export (CSV)	Complete
Docker deployment	Complete
Control dependency DAG	Complete
Security scanning	Complete

Capability	Status
REST API (FastAPI)	Built
Schema discovery	Built
Rule executor	Built

In Development

Capability	Timeline
Web dashboard (interactive)	Q3
AI-assisted mapping (Azure OpenAI)	Q4
Enterprise SSO (Entra ID)	Q4

Milestones

- 5 pilot customers in UK Financial Services
- Azure Marketplace listing
- ? ISO 27001 certification (Q4)
- ? First paid enterprise customer (Q3)

Year 2 - Enterprise Platform

Objective

Expand to multi-tenant SaaS with enterprise-grade capabilities.

Capability	Description	Priority
Multi-tenant architecture	Isolated customer workspaces	High
Interactive dashboard	Real-time migration quality visualisation	High
AI mapping recommendations	Azure OpenAI-powered schema matching	High
User management	RBAC, team collaboration	Medium
Advanced reporting	Custom report builder	Medium
API versioning	v2 API with enhanced capabilities	Medium
Power BI integration	Embedded analytics	Low

Milestones

- 30+ enterprise customers
- European market expansion
- 2+ system integrator partnerships
- Microsoft co-sell programme enrolment

Year 3 - AI-Powered Migration Intelligence

Objective

Transition from automated validation to intelligent migration decision support.

Capability	Description
Intelligent mapping engine	ML-powered schema matching with confidence scoring
Predictive risk scoring	AI models predict migration failure risk
Regulatory template library	Pre-built controls for Basel, SOX, FCA, PRA
Anomaly detection	AI identifies unusual data patterns during migration
Natural language queries	Ask questions about migration quality in plain English
Automated remediation suggestions	AI recommends fixes for failed controls

Milestones

- 100+ customers
- $10M+ ARR
- North America market entry
- Series A fundraising

Year 4+ - Intelligent Migration Platform

Objective

Become the comprehensive platform for migration governance and intelligence.

Capability	Description
AI agents	Autonomous migration monitoring and alerting
Microsoft Fabric integration	Enterprise data platform connectivity
Marketplace	Third-party control and integration marketplace
Multi-cloud	AWS, GCP migration validation support
Compliance automation	Automated regulatory reporting for migrations
Migration knowledge graph	Cross-project migration intelligence

Technology Roadmap

Capability	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4+

Capability	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4+
CLI Engine				
REST API				
PostgreSQL				
Docker				
Web Dashboard				
Azure OpenAI				
Multi-Tenant SaaS				
RBAC / SSO				
Power BI				
AI Mapping Engine				
Regulatory Templates				
Predictive Risk				
Microsoft Fabric				
Multi-Cloud				
AI Agents				
Marketplace				

Phase 2.9 - Investor FAQ

Version: 2.1

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Currency: GBP (£) - UK-based company

Company & Vision

1. What problem are you solving?

Financial Services institutions migrating data between systems lack automated validation tools. They rely on manual sampling, spreadsheets, and custom scripts - resulting in incomplete coverage, no audit trail, and high risk of undetected data errors. In regulated environments, this is unacceptable.

2. Why is this problem important now?

Three trends converge: (1) accelerating cloud migration in Financial Services, (2) increasing regulatory pressure for data integrity (FCA, PRA, Basel IV, SOX), and (3) retirement of legacy platform experts. Institutions need automated, governed, and audit-ready validation - not manual processes from a bygone era.

3. Who are your customers?

Tier 1-3 banks, insurance companies, asset managers, FinTechs, and regulated enterprises undergoing data migration. Initial focus on UK Financial Services, expanding to Europe and North America.

4. How large is the opportunity?

Global TAM estimated at $8-12B annually across Financial Services data migration, RegTech, and data validation. SAM of $1.5-2.5B for Azure-centric FSI organisations. SOM of $10-30M in Year 1-2.

Product

5. What does the platform do?

Automated data migration validation. It discovers source/target schemas, runs 10 structured validation controls (row counts, data types, keys, business rules, etc.), scores migration quality, enforces release gates, and produces audit-ready CSV exports.

6. What makes you different from ETL testing tools?

We're purpose-built for data migration, not generic ETL testing. Our 10 controls are standardised for migration validation. We include governance features (release gates, audit trails, dependency management) that ETL tools don't have. And we're focused specifically on regulated Financial Services.

7. Is your technology defensible?

Yes - our defensibility comes from: (1) domain expertise in Financial Services migration, (2) proprietary control framework (C01-C010), (3) modular Platform Core architecture, (4) customer implementation knowledge, and (5) regulatory alignment that generic tools can't easily replicate.

8. Do you use AI?

Our current platform is rule-based and metadata-driven - delivering reliable, deterministic validation. We plan to integrate Azure OpenAI for AI-assisted mapping recommendations in Phase 2. We prioritise accuracy and auditability over black-box AI.

Market

9. Who are your competitors?

Manual in-house solutions, ETL testing tools (QuerySurge, iCEDQ), data quality platforms (Informatica, Talend), Big 4 migration services (Accenture, Deloitte), and cloud migration tools (Azure Migrate). None offer our combination of migration-focused controls, governance, audit, and lightweight deployment.

10. Why will customers buy from you instead of building internally?

Building an equivalent platform requires expertise in migration validation, database internals, governance frameworks, and regulatory compliance - plus months of development. Our platform is ready to deploy today, standardised, and continuously improved.

11. What is your pricing model?

SaaS subscription - £1,500-£3,500/month (Starter), £3,500-£10,000/month (Professional), £10,000-£35,000/month (Enterprise), custom for Strategic deployments. Plus professional services for implementation (£15k-£40k) and custom controls (£5k-£20k each).

Business

12. What is your business model?

Recurring SaaS subscriptions with tiered pricing based on migration project volume and support level. Additional revenue from professional services and future AI modules.

13. What are your expected margins?

Gross margins of 80%+ as we scale, typical for SaaS platforms. Operating margins improve from Year 2 as development costs stabilise and revenue scales.

14. How will you acquire customers?

Founder-led direct sales to Financial Services CTOs and Heads of Data, Azure Marketplace listings, system integrator partnerships (Accenture, Deloitte, Infosys), and Microsoft co-sell programme.

15. What is your sales cycle?

2-4 months for mid-size banks and FinTech, 6-12 months for large Tier 1 banks. Pilot projects provide a faster entry path.

Funding

16. How much funding are you seeking?

£500,000-£750,000 seed round, or utilisation of Azure Founders Hub credits (up to £120,000) for initial infrastructure and development. As a UK-based company, we are also exploring Innovate UK Smart Grants and EIS-qualified angel investment.

17. How will the funds be used?

40% product development (Phase 2), 20% AI mapping module (Azure OpenAI), 20% customer pilots, 10% security certifications, 10% marketplace readiness.

18. What milestones will this funding achieve?

Product validation with 5+ Financial Services customers, Azure Marketplace listing, ISO 27001 certification, repeatable sales process, and £450k+ ARR.

Risks

19. What are the biggest risks?

Enterprise sales cycles are longer than consumer SaaS. Competition from established data quality vendors. Customer adoption of new validation methodologies. These are mitigated through pilot programmes, SI partnerships, and Financial Services domain focus.

20. What prevents Microsoft or a large vendor from copying you?

Large vendors move slowly in specialised niches. Our Financial Services domain expertise, migration-specific control framework, and customer implementation knowledge create a moat. We're not competing with Azure Migrate - we complement it.

Phase 2.10 - Demo Script

Version: 2.0

Product: FS Migration Validation Engine

Duration: 10-15 minutes

Objective

Demonstrate how the FS Migration Validation Engine automates data migration validation for Financial Services - from schema discovery through 10 validation controls, objective scoring, release gate enforcement, and audit-ready exports.

Demo Flow

Section	Duration
Introduction & Problem	1 min
Platform Overview	2 mins
Schema Discovery	2 mins
Validation Execution (C01-C010)	3 mins
Scoring & Release Gates	2 mins
Audit Export	2 mins
API Integration	1 min
Closing & Business Value	2 mins
Total	~15 minutes

1. Opening (1 Minute)

> *\"Financial Services institutions migrating data between systems face a critical challenge: how to ensure accuracy, completeness, and regulatory compliance when millions of records are in motion.*
>
> *Traditional approaches rely on manual sampling, spreadsheets, and custom scripts - which are slow, error-prone, and fail regulatory scrutiny.*
>
> *The FS Migration Validation Engine automates this process - providing complete validation coverage, objective scoring, governance, and audit-ready evidence.\"*

2. Platform Overview (2 Minutes)

Show the CLI interface and explain the architecture:

```
FS Migration Validation Engine v1.4
??? 10 Migration Controls (C01-C010)
??? Automated Scoring Engine
??? Release Gate Enforcement
??? Audit Export (CSV)
??? REST API (FastAPI)
??? Docker Deployment
```

\"The engine runs as a CLI tool, REST API, or Docker container. It connects to source and target databases, runs 10 standardised validation controls, scores the results, enforces release gates, and produces audit-ready CSV exports.\"

3. Schema Discovery (2 Minutes)

Show the discovery command:

```
python app/main.py discover --config config.yaml
```

Highlight:

- Automated connection to source and target databases
- Schema metadata extraction
- Table, column, and relationship discovery

\"The discovery engine automatically connects to source and target databases, extracts schema information, and builds a metadata repository. No manual schema documentation required.\"

4. Validation Execution (3 Minutes)

Show the run command:

```
python app/main.py run --config config.yaml
```

Walk through controls being executed:

Control	Description	Example Output
C01	Row count reconciliation	\"PASS - Source: 1,234,567 vs Target: 1,234,567\"
C02	Data type validation	\"PASS - All column types match\"
C03	Nullability check	\"PASS - All constraints satisfied\"
C04	Primary key integrity	\"PASS - No duplicates\"
C05	Foreign key integrity	\"PASS - All references valid\"
C06	Business rule validation	\"3 WARNINGS - See exception register\"

Control	Description	Example Output
C07-C010	Additional controls	\"PASS / WARN / FAIL per control\"

\"Each control runs independently with failure isolation. Results are captured with unique batch IDs for full traceability. The control dependency DAG ensures correct execution order - C02 waits for C01, C09 waits for C03.\"

5. Scoring & Release Gates (2 Minutes)

Show the scoring output:

```
Batch: ae40b96c-20da-4972-bb29-bff3c2451ae0
Overall Score: 87/100
Controls Passed: 8/10
Controls Warning: 2/10
Controls Failed: 0/10
RELEASE GATE: PASSED (minimum 80% threshold met)
Migration: APPROVED
```

\"The scoring engine produces objective, repeatable quality metrics. The release gate enforces a minimum quality threshold - if the score drops below 80%, the migration is blocked.\"

6. Audit Export (2 Minutes)

Show the export command:

```
python app/main.py export --config config.yaml --batch-id <id>
```

Show sample CSV output:

```
batch_id,control_id,status,score,exceptions,timestamp
ae40...,C01,PASS,100,0,2026-06-23 10:00:00
ae40...,C02,PASS,100,0,2026-06-23 10:00:05
ae40...,C06,WARN,70,3,2026-06-23 10:00:30
```

\"Every validation execution produces a complete audit trail - suitable for regulatory review. No manual evidence gathering required.\"

7. API Integration (1 Minute)

Show a sample API call:

```
curl -X POST https://api.example.com/api/v1/validate \\
  -H \"Content-Type: application/json\" \\
  -d '{\"project_id\": \"ae40...\", \"controls\": [\"C01\",\"C02\"]}'
```

\"The FastAPI REST API enables integration with existing CI/CD pipelines, deployment workflows, and enterprise toolchains.\"

8. Closing Summary (2 Minutes)

\"In just a few minutes, we've demonstrated:

Automated schema discovery - No manual analysis required

10 structured validation controls - Complete, standardised coverage

Objective scoring - Repeatable quality metrics

Release gate governance - Automated migration approval/blocking

Audit-ready exports - CSV evidence for regulatory review

The platform is Azure-native, Docker-deployable, and purpose-built for regulated Financial Services data migration.

Our mission is to transform data migration validation from a manual, high-risk exercise into an automated, governed, and audit-ready process.\"

Demo Environment Requirements

Item	Details
Engine	Running instance of FS Migration Validation Engine
Databases	Source and target PostgreSQL databases with demo data
Configuration	config.yaml with DemoBank settings
CLI	Terminal with Python environment activated
Sample Data	sql/demo/ - demo source and target data scripts
Backup	engine_backup.sql, source_backup.sql, target_backup.sql

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Key Messages to Reinforce

1. Purpose-built for Financial Services - Not a generic ETL tool
2. Automated and repeatable - Same inputs, same outputs, every time
3. Governance-first - Release gates, audit trails, compliance built-in
4. Lightweight deployment - Docker-native, deploy in minutes
5. Azure-native - Built for the Microsoft ecosystem

6. Enterprise-ready - Secure, scalable, auditable